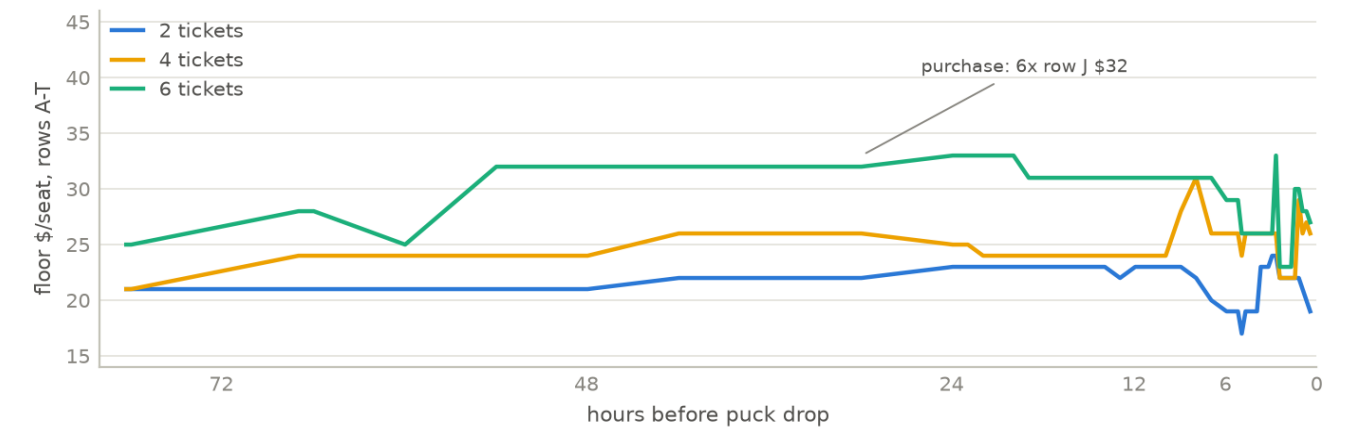


# What an NHL ticket market actually prices

Kraken vs Flames, Sept 24, 2026, Climate Pledge Arena. 50 snapshots over 78 hours, ~72k listing observations across 22 NHL games, Sept 21-24. Prices are Gametime base (all-in) prices; app display runs 0-10% higher.

The common question, **when is the floor?**, is the wrong unit of analysis. The resale market prices three separate goods: **entry** (any seat), **proximity** (row depth), and **contiguity** (seats together). Each has its own supply dynamics and therefore its own clock. Only entry gets cheaper as the game approaches; proximity and contiguity get scarcer, and their combination is the scarcest good in the building.



Cheapest lower-bowl listing in rows A-T by purchase quantity. The 2-ticket line barely moves for three days; the 6-ticket line carries a persistent premium that collapses only in one brief window near T-2.5h, after which quality blocks are simply gone.

## The decision matrix this game (and 21 league games) supports

|                       | 1-2 tickets                                                             | 3-4 tickets                                                                             | 5-6 tickets                                                                             |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Any row (entry)       | Wait freely. Floor \$19-23 throughout; best late (T-90m to T+30m).      | Wait. \$19-22 in final 2h; odd quantities ride thinner supply (3 can cost more than 4). | Even 6 entered for \$19-20 at T-60m in this soft market. Risky in hot ones.             |
| Rows A-T (quality)    | Timing barely matters (\$5 range). Buy on a good-row wave, not a clock. | \$24-26 band; waves at T-2.5h reached \$22.                                             | \$31-33 for days; one dip to \$23 at T-2.5h, gone in ~30 min.                           |
| Rows A-J (front half) | Spiky, listing-driven (\$19-48). Selection beats timing.                | Buy when seen; supply is a handful of listings.                                         | Best prices appeared days out (\$27-28 Tue) and were picked off. Never discounted late. |

## Why this structure exists, and where the edge is

- 1. Contiguity is consumed, never replenished.** Large blocks fragment as sellers split them; no mechanism recombines seats. Across 10 fully-instrumented league games (Sept 22), group-capable quality inventory died in the final 1-3 hours in 7 of 9 markets; at MSG it went 8 options to zero by T-1h.
- 2. Deals arrive as perishable waves, not trends.** Individual sellers capitulate at unpredictable moments; the resulting mispricings survive hours, not days (a 6-seat row J block at \$28 lasted under 12 hours; the \$23 convergence window lasted ~30 minutes). Monitoring beats scheduling.
- 3. The platform's own model underprices proximity.** Gametime's fair value  $V$  (recoverable as  $\text{price} / \text{deal\_score}$ ) rated row J barely above row W in the same sections (\$85 vs \$81). Its deal badges therefore fail to flag exactly the listings a row-sensitive buyer values most, which is why they sit unsold for hours. That gap between the model's value function and a human's is the systematic edge this dataset can keep measuring.

Caveats: one home game, preseason demand, soft-market regime; regular season (from Oct 4) may shift levels and timing, and the collector is already gathering that data. Floors exclude junk listings (deal score > 1.5). Generated Sept 25, 2026 from the sports-tickets pipeline.